IELTS SPEAKING • TOPIC 21

CHALLENGES

Natural collocations • Advanced grammar structures • Sample answer

PART 1 • QUESTIONS

- Do you like challenges?
- What was the hardest thing you did recently?
- How do you deal with difficulties?

PART 2 • CUE CARD

Describe a tough challenge you have faced.

You should say:

- what it was
- when it happened
- what you did
- what you learned

PART 3 • QUESTIONS

- Why do some people enjoy risky challenges?
- Do challenges make people stronger?
- How can parents prepare children for difficulties?

50	12	62	124
collocations	structures	Band 8 stories	your sentences

START HERE

One plan for every “challenges” card

- A tough challenge you have faced
- A difficult decision you made
- A time you took a risk
- A problem you solved
- A time you worked under pressure
- A time you had to be brave
- A difficult task at school or work
- A time you helped someone through hard times

What the challenge was → **When** it happened → **What** you did → **What** you learned

HOW TO READ EACH CARD

Tarjima + definition — o‘zbekcha ma’nosi va oddiy inglizcha izohi.

Band 8 story — iborani ro‘yxat emas, mini hikoya ichida ishlatish namunasi.

≈ Yaqin iboralar — shu ma’noga yaqin yana 2 ta natural ibora.

Qachon ishlatiladi — qaysi vaziyatda va qanday grammatika bilan.

Namuna gap — bitta tayyor gap. Keyin o‘zingiz 2 ta gap yozing.

Speaking ball — shu ibora gapirishda qanchalik foydali (10 dan).

10 / 10	Signature ibora: Band 8 ni ko‘rsatadi, ko‘p topiclarda ishlaydi.
8–9	Kuchli va moslashuvchan: tabiiy eshitiladi, ball oshiradi.
6–7	Foydali va ishonchli: asos sifatida yaxshi.
4–5	Vaziyatga bog‘liq yoki oddiyroq: faqat mos kelganda ishlating.

Describing the difficulty

COLLOCATIONS 1 / 5

1 a daunting task

8/10 SPEAKING BALL

qo‘rqitadigan, og‘ir vazifa • *a job that looks so hard or so big that it makes you nervous*

BAND 8 STORY

Writing a thesis of eighty pages felt like **a daunting task** at first. I stared at the empty page for an hour, then forced myself to write one paragraph, and that was how it began.

≈ **an intimidating job** — qo‘rqituvchi ish

≈ **a mountain to climb** — zo‘r mehnat talab qiladigan ish

Qachon ishlatiladi: Vazifa haqida: a daunting task / prospect / challenge. ‘daunting‘ - ‘qo‘rqitadigan‘. Part 2 da ‘what it was‘ qismini ta‘riflash uchun mos.

Namuna gap: Moving to a new country alone seemed **a daunting task** at first.

SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

2 a tall order

7/10 SPEAKING BALL

bajarish juda qiyin talab • *something that is very difficult to achieve or to do*

BAND 8 STORY

My boss wanted the whole report in two days, which was **a tall order** because I was also preparing for exams. Still, I made a list, worked in short bursts, and we finished with an hour to spare.

≈ **a big ask** — katta talab

≈ **easier said than done** — aytish oson, qilish qiyin

Qachon ishlatiladi: Norasmiy: be a tall order (for + kim). ‘a‘ bilan. Haddan ortiq talabni ko‘rsatadi; Part 1 ‘hardest thing‘ savolida ham mos.

Namuna gap: Learning fluent English in three months is **a tall order**.

SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

3 out of my comfort zone

10/10 SPEAKING BALL

o‘zim uchun noqulay vaziyatda • *in a situation where you feel nervous because it is new or difficult*

BAND 8 STORY

Speaking to a hundred strangers was completely **out of my comfort zone**. My hands were shaking before I started, but after my first joke the audience smiled, and I forgot to be afraid.

≈ **outside my depth** — bilimim yetmaydigan joyda

≈ **unfamiliar territory** — notanish hudud

Qachon ishlatiladi: Part 1 ‘Do you like challenges?‘: step out of / be out of one’s comfort zone. ‘zone‘ birlikda. Eng ko‘p ishlatiladigan iboralardan biri.

Namuna gap: Joining a drama club pushed me **out of my comfort zone**.

SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

4 be thrown in at the deep end

8/10 SPEAKING BALL

tayyorgarliksiz og‘ir ishga tashlanmoq • *to be given a difficult job with no preparation or help*

BAND 8 STORY

On my first day at the clinic I was **thrown in at the deep end**. The nurse handed me a list of twenty patients and disappeared, so I learnt everything by watching and asking.

≈ **sink or swim** — yo yo‘q bo‘l, yo chiq

≈ **be left to my own devices** — o‘z holimga tashlab qo‘yilmoq

Qachon ishlatiladi: Idiom: be thrown in at the deep end (passiv). Tayyorgarliksiz qiyin ish. Ish va o‘qish haqida Part 2 da kuchli ibora.

Namuna gap: New teachers are often **thrown in at the deep end** and have to learn quickly.

SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

5 a steep learning curve

8/10 SPEAKING BALL

tez va qiyin o‘rganish davri • *a situation in which you have to learn a lot very quickly*

BAND 8 STORY

My first month abroad was **a steep learning curve**. I had to cook, handle the bank and find the right bus, all in a language I was still learning.

≈ **a crash course** — jadal o‘rganish

≈ **a baptism of fire** — og‘ir sinov

Qachon ishlatiladi: Yangi ish yoki joyga moslashish: a steep learning curve (‘steep’ - tik). ‘a’ bilan. Part 2 ‘what it was’ va ‘what I learned’ qismlarida.

Namuna gap: Starting a business was **a steep learning curve** for my aunt.

SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

6 a make-or-break moment

7/10 SPEAKING BALL

hal qiluvchi, yo‘q-yo‘q lahza • *a time when something will either succeed or completely fail*

BAND 8 STORY

The final presentation was **a make-or-break moment** for my project. If the committee didn’t like it, I would lose a full year, so I rehearsed until my roommates could recite it.

≈ **a critical moment** — muhim lahza

≈ **a crunch point** — tanqidiy nuqta

Qachon ishlatiladi: Chiziqchalar bilan: a make-or-break moment / decision. Eng muhim sinov haqida. Part 2 hikoyasida taranglikni oshiradi.

Namuna gap: The job interview was **a make-or-break moment** for her career.

SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

7 bite off more than I can chew

7/10 SPEAKING BALL

kuchim yetmaydigan ishga qo‘l urmoq • *to try to do too much at the same time*

BAND 8 STORY

In my final year I took three courses and a night job, and soon I realised I had **bitten off more than I could chew**. I was exhausted, my grades dropped, and I finally gave up the extra course.

≈ **overstretch myself** — o‘zimni ortiqcha ishga solmoq

≈ **take on too much** — ko‘p ishni zimmaga olmoq

Qachon ishlatiladi: Idiom: bite off more than one can chew (o‘tgan: more than I could chew). Haddan ortiq ish olish haqida. Norasmiy; Part 1 va 2 da.

Namuna gap: I **bit off more than I could chew** when I agreed to organise the whole event.

SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

8 a rough patch

8/10 SPEAKING BALL

og‘ir davr • *a difficult period in life when many things go wrong*

BAND 8 STORY

My family went through **a rough patch** when my father lost his job. I started tutoring younger kids after school, and the small money I earned helped us more than my own grades did.

≈ **a difficult period** — qiyin davr

≈ **a bad spell** — yomon davr

Qachon ishlatiladi: Yomon davr: go through / hit a rough patch. ‘patch’ - ‘bo‘lak, davr’. Norasmiy; Part 1 ‘hardest thing‘ savoliga mos.

Namuna gap: Every friendship goes through **a rough patch** now and then.

SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

9 a major hurdle

8/10 SPEAKING BALL

katta to‘siq • *a big problem that you must solve before you can succeed*

BAND 8 STORY

The language barrier was **a major hurdle** in my first week abroad. I couldn’t read the signs, but I started with five new words a day, and in a month I could order lunch confidently.

≈ **a serious obstacle** — jiddiy to‘siq

≈ **a stumbling block** — qoqilish toshi

Qachon ishlatiladi: To‘siq: face / overcome / clear a hurdle. ‘hurdle’ - sportdagi to‘siq. Rasmiy-neytral; Part 2 va 3 da ishlating.

Namuna gap: The lack of money was **a major hurdle** for many young entrepreneurs.

SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

10 under immense pressure

8/10
SPEAKING BALL

juda katta bosim ostida • *in a situation where you feel very stressed because much is expected of you*

BAND 8 STORY

I was **under immense pressure** during exam week, because my scholarship depended on the results. I turned my phone off, slept eight hours and, strangely, that calmed everything down.

≈ **under a lot of stress** — ko‘p stress ostida

≈ **feeling the heat** — bosimni sezmoq

Qachon ishlatiladi: Bosim: be / work / perform under pressure; immense / enormous pressure. ‘under’ predlogi. Part 2 da qiyinchilik darajasini ko‘rsatadi.

Namuna gap: Surgeons often have to make decisions **under immense pressure**.

SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

11 rise to the challenge

9/10 SPEAKING BALL

sinovga munosib javob bermoq • *to deal with a difficult situation successfully*

BAND 8 STORY
When our team leader got sick, I had to **rise to the challenge** and run the project. I was terrified, but I divided the tasks carefully and, to my surprise, we finished on time.

≈ **meet the challenge** — sinovga javob bermoq

≈ **step up to the plate** — mas'uliyatni zimmasiga olmoq

Qachon ishlatiladi: Idiom: rise to the challenge / the occasion. 'to' predlogi. Qiyin vaziyatda o'zini ko'rsatish haqida Part 2 da juda mos.

Namuna gap: Young people often **rise to the challenge** when adults trust them.

SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

12 tackle a problem head-on

8/10 SPEAKING BALL

muammoni to'g'ridan-to'g'ri hal qilmoq • *to deal with a difficulty directly and bravely, not to avoid it*

BAND 8 STORY
Instead of hiding from my low grades, I decided to **tackle the problem head-on** and talk to my teacher. She showed me three mistakes I kept repeating, and my next test went much better.

≈ **face it squarely** — yuziga to'g'ri qaramoq

≈ **confront the issue** — muammoga duch kelmoq

BOSHQA FOYDALI MA'NO
(futbolda) to'pni olib qo'ymoq, yiqitmoq — He **tackled** the striker just outside the penalty area.

Qachon ishlatiladi: Muammoni to'g'ridan-to'g'ri hal qilish: tackle (a problem / an issue) head-on. 'head-on' chiziqcha bilan. Part 1 'How do you deal with difficulties?' savoliga.

Namuna gap: It is better to **tackle** conflicts **head-on** than to ignore them.

SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

13 take it one step at a time

8/10 SPEAKING BALL

bosqichma-bosqich harakat qilmoq • *to deal with something gradually so that it does not feel too big*

BAND 8 STORY
When the workload became huge, my mentor told me to **take it one step at a time**. I wrote the three most urgent tasks on a sticky note and finished them before dinner, and the panic disappeared.

≈ **one day at a time** — kunma-kun

≈ **go step by step** — qadamma-qadam bormoq

Qachon ishlatiladi: Maslahat va yondashuv: take it one step at a time (take things ham). Qiyin vazifa bilan ishlash usuli. Part 1 va 2 da ishlating.

Namuna gap: I try to **take it one step at a time** when a project seems overwhelming.

SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

14 break it down into smaller steps

8/10 SPEAKING BALL

kichik bosqichlarga bo‘lmoq • *to divide a big task into small parts that are easier to do*

BAND 8 STORY

A thirty-page essay sounds impossible, so I **broke it down into smaller steps**: research on Monday, outline on Tuesday, one section per day. By Sunday I was just editing.

≈ **divide it into manageable chunks** — boshqariladigan bo‘laklarga bo‘lmoq

≈ **split it into stages** — bosqichlarga bo‘lmoq

BOSHQA FOYDALI MA’NO

(mashina, apparat) buzilmoq — Our car **broke down** halfway to the village.

Qachon ishlatiladi: Katta ishni bo‘lish: break + ot + down into + smaller steps / parts. Ajraladigan fe’l: break it down. Part 1 va 2 ‘what you did’ qismida.

Namuna gap: Experts advise students to **break** big projects **down into smaller steps**.

SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

15 weigh up my options

8/10 SPEAKING BALL

variantlarni solishtirib ko‘rmoq • *to think carefully about the good and bad points of different choices*

BAND 8 STORY

Before changing my major, I sat down and **weighed up my options** for a whole weekend. I listed pros and cons for each, called two seniors, and in the end the decision felt calm and clear.

≈ **consider my choices** — tanlovlarimni ko‘rib chiqmoq

≈ **think it over** — bir o‘ylab ko‘rmoq

Qachon ishlatiladi: Qaror: weigh up (the pros and cons / my options). Britancha ‘weigh up’, Amerikacha ko‘proq ‘weigh’. Part 2 ‘what you did’ qismida.

Namuna gap: Take your time to **weigh up your options** before making a big decision.

SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

16 keep a cool head

8/10 SPEAKING BALL

o‘zini xotirjam tutmoq • *to stay calm in a difficult or stressful situation*

BAND 8 STORY

When the lights went out in the middle of my speech, I **kept a cool head** and carried on without the slides. Afterwards many people said the story felt even more natural without the screen.

≈ **stay calm** — xotirjam qolmoq

≈ **keep my composure** — vazminlikni saqlamoq

Qachon ishlatiladi: Idiom: keep a cool head. ‘head’ birlikda. Qiyin vaziyatda va bosim ostida xotirjamlikni ko‘rsatadi; Part 1 va 2 da.

Namuna gap: Good drivers **keep a cool head** when the traffic gets heavy.

SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

17 think on my feet

8/10 SPEAKING BALL

darhol topqirlik bilan harakat qilmoq • *to react quickly and sensibly without time to prepare*

BAND 8 STORY
During the interview the panel asked a question I hadn't prepared for, so I had to **think on my feet**. I breathed in, gave an example from my own life, and they actually smiled.

≈ **improvise** — tayyorgarliksiz harakat qilmoq

≈ **react quickly** — tez javob bermoq

Qachon ishlatiladi: Norasmiy: think on one's feet (egalik o'zgaradi). Intervyu, taqdimot va ish haqida. Part 1 'How do you deal with difficulties?' ga ham mos.

Namuna gap: Teachers need to **think on their feet** when a lesson goes wrong.

SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

18 get through a tough time

8/10 SPEAKING BALL

qiyin davrdan o'tib olmoq • *to survive a difficult period or finish something unpleasant*

BAND 8 STORY
I don't know how I **got through** that winter, working two jobs. What helped was a small notebook where I wrote one good thing per day, and I still keep it on my shelf.

≈ **make it through** — omon o'tib olmoq

≈ **survive** — omon qolmoq

BOSHQA FOYDALI MA'NO
(telefon orqali) bog'lana olmoq — I couldn't **get through** to the doctor's office.

Qachon ishlatiladi: Qiyin davr: get through + a tough time / the week / exams. 'get through' ajralmaydigan frazal fe'l. Part 1 va 2 da ishlatiladi.

Namuna gap: Friends helped me **get through** the hardest weeks of my life.

SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

19 lean on someone

7/10 SPEAKING BALL

kimgadir tayanmoq, yordam so'ramoq • *to depend on someone for support when you have difficulties*

BAND 8 STORY
During my exams I **leaned on** my older sister more than ever. She cooked dinner, listened to my complaints at midnight and never asked for anything back.

≈ **turn to** — murojaat qilmoq

≈ **rely on** — tayanmoq

BOSHQA FOYDALI MA'NO
(biror narsaga) suyanmoq — He **leaned on** the fence and watched the game.

Qachon ishlatiladi: Yordam: lean on + kim (for support). Ajralmaydigan frazal fe'l. Norasmiy; Part 1 'How do you deal with difficulties?' ga mos.

Namuna gap: In hard times, I **lean on** my family and close friends.

SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

20 reach out for support

7/10
SPEAKING BALL

yordam so‘ramoq, murojaat qilmoq • *to ask other people for help when you cannot cope alone*

BAND 8 STORY

At first I was too proud to ask, but eventually I **reached out for support**. A senior student I hardly knew spent two evenings explaining the topic to me, and I will never forget that kindness.

≈ **ask for help** — yordam so‘ramoq

≈ **seek advice** — maslahat izlamoq

Qachon ishlatiladi: Yordam so‘rash: reach out (to someone) for + support / help. Zamonaviy, yarim rasmiy ibora; Part 1 va 3 da ishlatiladi.

Namuna gap: Don’t be afraid to **reach out for support** when things get too much.

SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

21 hit rock bottom

7/10 SPEAKING BALL

eng quyi nuqtaga tushmoq • *to reach the worst possible point in a difficult time*

BAND 8 STORY
After failing the entrance exam twice, I felt I had **hit rock bottom**. I stayed in my room for a week, but then my grandfather simply put a book in my hands, and slowly I started again.

≈ **reach my lowest point** — eng quyi nuqtaga yetmoq

≈ **touch the bottom** — tubiga tegmoq

Qachon ishlatiladi: Idiom: hit rock bottom ('rock bottom' - eng quyi nuqta). Salbiy hissiyotli davr; norasmiy. Part 2 da burilishdan oldingi lahza.

Namuna gap: He **hit rock bottom** after losing his job and his home.

SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

22 burn out

8/10 SPEAKING BALL

ortiqcha ishdan charchab tugamoq • *to become extremely tired because of too much work or stress*

BAND 8 STORY
I worked every night and weekend for three months, and finally I **burnt out**. I couldn't concentrate, I felt angry for no reason, and the doctor told me firmly to rest.

≈ **wear myself out** — o'zimni charchatib qo'ymoq

≈ **run myself into the ground** — o'zimni ish bilan holdan toydirmoq

BOSHQA FOYDALI MA'NO
(lampochka) kuyib ketmoq — The old bulb finally **burned out** last night.

Qachon ishlatiladi: Stress oqibati: burn out (fe'l), burnout (ot, chiziqchasiz). Burn yourself out ham bo'ladi. Part 3 da ish va o'qish stressi haqida.

Namuna gap: Many young doctors **burn out** because of long shifts.

SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

23 lose sleep over

8/10 SPEAKING BALL

tashvishdan uyqusini yo'qotmoq • *to worry so much about something that you cannot sleep*

BAND 8 STORY
I **lost sleep over** the final project for weeks. I kept imagining everything that could go wrong, until my roommate suggested writing my worries on paper, and strangely that helped.

≈ **toss and turn** — karavotda g'ing'illamoq

≈ **be kept awake by worry** — tashvishdan uxlay olmaslik

Qachon ishlatiladi: Tashvish: lose sleep over + ot. Salbiy gapda tez-tez: don't lose sleep over it. Norasmiy; Part 1 da stress haqida.

Namuna gap: There is no point in **losing sleep over** things you can't change.

SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

24 at the end of my tether

6/10 SPEAKING BALL

sabr kosasi to‘lgan, chidamim tugagan • *so tired or stressed that you cannot deal with any more problems*

BAND 8 STORY

By the third week of night shifts I was **at the end of my tether**. I snapped at my little brother over nothing, and when I saw his face, I knew I had to change something.

≈ **at my wits’ end** — aqlim lol bo‘lgan

≈ **at breaking point** — chidam chegarasida

Qachon ishlatiladi: Idiom: at the end of one’s tether (egalik o‘zgaradi). Britancha; AmE: at the end of one’s rope. Chidam tugaganini ko‘rsatadi.

Namuna gap: She was **at the end of her tether** after weeks without a day off.

SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

25 on the verge of giving up

8/10 SPEAKING BALL

taslim bo‘lish arafasida • *very close to stopping because something is too difficult*

BAND 8 STORY

I was **on the verge of giving up** when my coach sent me a short message saying one more week. I stayed, and that one week turned into the best result of my whole season.

≈ **on the brink of quitting** — tashlab ketish arafasida

≈ **about to throw in the towel** — taslim bo‘lish arafasida

Qachon ishlatiladi: Arafa: on the verge of + -ing / ot (on the verge of tears). ‘verge of’ dan keyin -ing. Part 2 ‘what happened’ qismida burilishdan oldin.

Namuna gap: Many students are **on the verge of giving up** just before the exams.

SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

26 a nervous wreck

7/10 SPEAKING BALL

asabi tarang, butunlay charchagan odam • *a person who is extremely worried and cannot relax*

BAND 8 STORY

The night before my driving test I was **a nervous wreck**. I checked the map ten times, my hands wouldn’t stop shaking, and my mum finally made me tea and turned off the lights.

≈ **a bundle of nerves** — asabiy odam

≈ **on edge** — asabiy holatda

Qachon ishlatiladi: Norasmiy: be / feel a nervous wreck. ‘wreck’ - ‘vayrona’. Imtihon va intervyu oldidagi hayajonni ifodalashda mos.

Namuna gap: I was **a nervous wreck** before my first speech.

SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

27 sleepless nights

7/10 SPEAKING BALL

uyqusiz kechalar • *nights when you cannot sleep because you are worried*

BAND 8 STORY

That project cost me many **sleepless nights**. I would lie there, rewriting the speech in my head, and by morning I was more tired than before I went to bed.

≈ **restless nights** — bezovta kechalar

≈ **nights of worry** — tashvishli kechalar

Qachon ishlatiladi: Doim ko'plikda: have / suffer sleepless nights (over + ot). Stress va tashvish haqida Part 1 va 2 da.

Namuna gap: The decision gave me many **sleepless nights**.

SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

28 take its toll

9/10 SPEAKING BALL

salbiy ta'sir qilmoq, charchatmoq • *to cause damage or tiredness after a long time*

BAND 8 STORY

Working and studying at the same time began to **take its toll** on me. I got ill twice in a month, and my teacher gently advised me to reduce my hours.

≈ **wear me down** — meni holdan toydirmoq

≈ **have a negative impact on** — salbiy ta'sir ko'rsatmoq

Qachon ishlatiladi: Ta'sir: take its toll on + kim / nima ('its' doim o'zgarmaydi). Ega - stress, vaqt, ish. Rasmiy-neytral; Part 3 da ham mos.

Namuna gap: Constant stress can **take its toll** on a person's health.

SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

29 weigh on my mind

7/10 SPEAKING BALL

xayolimni band qilmoq, bezovta qilmoq • *to make you worry or think about it all the time*

BAND 8 STORY

The unfinished essay was **weighing on my mind** all weekend. I tried watching a film, but I kept stopping it, and finally I opened my laptop and wrote the first page just to feel lighter.

≈ **play on my mind** — xayolimdan ketmaslik

≈ **nag at me** — meni bezovta qilmoq

Qachon ishlatiladi: Tashvish: weigh on someone's mind / weigh heavily on. Ega - muammo. 'heavily' bilan kuchayadi. Part 2 da hissiy holatni ko'rsatadi.

Namuna gap: The exam results were **weighing on my mind** all week.

SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

30 fall apart

6/10
SPEAKING BALL

ruhan qulab tushmoq, hammasi buzilmoq • *to be so upset that you cannot function, or for a plan to fail completely*

BAND 8 STORY

When the news came, I thought everything would **fall apart**. Instead, my friends gathered around me, we made a new plan over late-night tea, and the problem became smaller.

≈ **go to pieces** — parcha-parcha bo‘lmoq

≈ **break down** — qulab tushmoq

BOSHQA FOYDALI MA’NO

(narsa) bo‘laklarga bo‘linib tushmoq — The old chair **fell apart** when he sat down.

Qachon ishlatiladi: Salbiy holat: fall apart (rejalar yoki odam haqida). Ajralmaydigan frazal fe’l. Norasmiy. Part 2 da eng og‘ir lahzani ko‘rsatadi.

Namuna gap: Don’t **fall apart** if your first attempt fails; try a different method.

SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

31 learn the hard way

9/10 SPEAKING BALL

achchiq tajriba bilan o‘rganmoq • *to learn something through a bad experience instead of advice*

BAND 8 STORY

I **learnt the hard way** that leaving everything to the last night doesn’t work. I stayed up till dawn, mixed up my notes and got a poor mark, and since then I plan my time weeks ahead.

≈ **learn from bitter experience** — achchiq tajribadan o‘rganmoq

≈ **pay the price for my mistake** — xatoning haqini to‘lamoq

Qachon ishlatiladi: Idiom: learn the hard way (that + gap). Qiyinchilikdan olingan saboq. Part 2 ‘what you learned’ qismiga ideal ibora.

Namuna gap: Many students **learn the hard way** that cramming does not work.

SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

32 come out of it stronger

10/10 SPEAKING BALL

undan kuchliroq bo‘lib chiqmoq • *to be a better, tougher person after a difficult time*

BAND 8 STORY

I won’t pretend it was easy, but I **came out of it stronger**. I now know that I can work under pressure and that my friends will always show up when I need them.

≈ **grow from the experience** — tajribadan o‘sib chiqmoq

≈ **emerge tougher** — chiniqib chiqmoq

Qachon ishlatiladi: Natija: come out (of it) stronger / wiser. ‘stronger’ - qiyosiy daraja. Part 2 xulosasida ‘what I learned’ bilan ishlatiladi.

Namuna gap: Most people **come out** of difficult times **stronger** than before.

SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

33 a blessing in disguise

8/10 SPEAKING BALL

niqoblangan baxt, yaxshilik uchun • *something that seems bad at first but later turns out to be good*

BAND 8 STORY

Losing my first job looked like a disaster, but it was **a blessing in disguise**. I used the free time to learn programming, and a year later I found a better position.

≈ **a hidden benefit** — yashirin foyda

≈ **a silver lining** — yaxshi tomoni

Qachon ishlatiladi: Idiom: be a blessing in disguise. ‘disguise’ - niqob. Salbiy voqea keyin foydali bo‘lib chiqqanda; Part 1 va 2 da ishlatiladi.

Namuna gap: Missing the bus was **a blessing in disguise** because I met my future colleague.

SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

34 grow as a person

8/10 SPEAKING BALL

shaxs sifatida o‘smoq • *to become more mature and understand yourself and life better*

BAND 8 STORY

That year helped me **grow as a person**. Before it I always waited for others to decide, but afterwards I learnt to trust my own judgement, even when it was uncomfortable.

≈ **mature as a person** — shaxs sifatida yetilmoq

≈ **develop personally** — shaxsan rivojlanmoq

Qachon ishlatiladi: O‘sish: grow as a person (as a leader / writer). ‘as’ predlogi. Tajribadan olingan foydani aytishda Part 2 da.

Namuna gap: Living alone forced me to **grow as a person**.

SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

35 toughen up

6/10 SPEAKING BALL

chiniqmoq, qattiqroq bo‘lmoq • *to become stronger and better able to deal with difficulties*

BAND 8 STORY

My first year away from home made me **toughen up**. I stopped calling my mother about every little problem, and, funny enough, she says I have become the calmest one in the family.

≈ **become more resilient** — chidamliroq bo‘lmoq

≈ **harden myself** — o‘zimni chiniqtirmoq

Qachon ishlatiladi: Norasmiy: toughen up (frazal fe’l). ‘You should toughen up’ boshqaga aytilsa qo‘pol; o‘zingiz haqingizda ishlating.

Namuna gap: Competitive sports help children **toughen up**.

SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

36 put things in perspective

8/10 SPEAKING BALL

voqealarga to‘g‘ri baho bermoq • *to understand how important or unimportant something really is*

BAND 8 STORY

Volunteering at a hospital **put things in perspective** for me. After seeing people fight real illnesses, my worries about grades felt much smaller, and I slept better that night.

≈ **keep things in proportion** — narsalarga mutanosib qaramoq

≈ **give me a sense of proportion** — o‘lchov hissini bermoq

Qachon ishlatiladi: Perspektiva: put things in perspective (ega - tajriba yoki voqea). Ibora o‘zgarmas. Part 2 ‘what I learned’ qismida chuqurlik beradi.

Namuna gap: Travelling to poorer countries can **put** your own problems **in perspective**.

SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

37 build character

7/10 SPEAKING BALL

xarakterni chiniqtirmoq • *to develop strong personal qualities such as patience and honesty*

BAND 8 STORY

My grandfather says that hardship **builds character**, and he proved it every day. He got up at five to work in the fields, and he never complained, even when the harvest was poor.

≈ **form a strong personality** — kuchli shaxsni shakllantirmoq

≈ **shape who you are** — kimligingizni shakllantirmoq

Qachon ishlatiladi: Keksa avlod uslubi: build character (sanalmaydigan ot, 'a' siz). Qiyinchilikning foydasini tushuntirishda Part 3 da ham yaxshi.

Namuna gap: Overcoming obstacles **builds character** in young people.

SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

38 no pain, no gain

6/10 SPEAKING BALL

mehnatsiz rohat yo'q • *a saying that success needs hard work, effort or suffering*

BAND 8 STORY

My running coach always repeats that there is **no pain, no gain**. I used to laugh at it, but after months of sore legs and early mornings, I finally understood what he meant.

≈ **nothing comes easy** — hech narsa oson kelmaydi

≈ **you reap what you sow** — ekkaningni o'rasan

Qachon ishlatiladi: Maqol: no pain, no gain. Ko'pincha sport va o'qishda. Iqtibos sifatida ishlating, ko'p aytmang; Part 3 'Do challenges make people stronger?' savoliga.

Namuna gap: Learning a language is difficult, but **no pain, no gain**.

SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

39 pull through

7/10 SPEAKING BALL

og'ir ahvoldan omon chiqmoq • *to survive or recover from a very difficult time or illness*

BAND 8 STORY

When my father was ill, the whole family worried, but he **pulled through** thanks to the doctors and our prayers. It made all of us appreciate small, ordinary days much more.

≈ **make it through** — omon o'tmoq

≈ **recover from** — tuzalib ketmoq

Qachon ishlatiladi: Og'ir davr yoki kasallikdan chiqish: pull through (ajralmas). Odam yoki oila haqida; hissiyotli. Part 2 'what I learned' qismida.

Namuna gap: With determination, the small business **pulled through** the crisis.

SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

40 take it in my stride

8/10
SPEAKING BALL

xotirjam qabul qilmoq, jiddiy olmaslik • *to deal with a difficult thing calmly without being upset*

BAND 8 STORY

My teacher was strict, and many classmates found her tests terrifying, but I learnt to **take it in my stride**. I breathed, read the questions twice and tried not to compare myself with others.

≈ **handle it calmly** — xotirjam hal qilmoq

≈ **shrug it off** — parvo qilmaslik

Qachon ishlatiladi: Idiom: take something in one's stride (AmE: in stride). Qiyin vaziyatga xotirjam munosabat. Part 1 'How do you deal with difficulties?' ga mos.

Namuna gap: She **took** the bad news **in her stride** and started looking for solutions.

SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

Part 3: risk, resilience and parenting

COLLOCATIONS 5 / 5

41 a thrill-seeker

7/10 SPEAKING BALL

hayajon qidiruvchi odam • *a person who loves exciting and sometimes dangerous activities*

BAND 8 STORY

My cousin is **a thrill-seeker**: he skis, skydives and once climbed a mountain without telling anyone. We worry about him, but he says that ordinary life makes him feel half asleep.

≈ **an adrenaline junkie** — adrenalinga qaram odam

≈ **a risk-taker** — tavakkalchi

Qachon ishlatiladi: Part 3 'Why do some people enjoy risky challenges?': a thrill-seeker (chiziqcha). Norasmiy, ko'pincha ijobiy yoki hazil ohangda.

Namuna gap: **Thrill-seekers** often choose extreme sports to feel alive.

SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

42 an adrenaline rush

8/10 SPEAKING BALL

adrenalin to'lqini, kuchli hayajon • *a sudden strong feeling of excitement and energy*

BAND 8 STORY

Skiing down a steep hill gave me **an adrenaline rush** I had never felt before. My heart was pounding, but when I reached the bottom, I was laughing like a child.

≈ **a surge of excitement** — hayajon to'lqini

≈ **a buzz** — zavq-shavq

Qachon ishlatiladi: Hayajon: get / feel an adrenaline rush. 'rush' sanaladi. Part 3 da nega ba'zi odamlar xavf-xatarni yoqtirishini tushuntiradi.

Namuna gap: Many people love extreme sports for **an adrenaline rush** that ordinary hobbies can't offer.

SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

43 a calculated risk

8/10 SPEAKING BALL

o'ylab ko'rilgan tavakkal • *a risk taken after thinking carefully about the possible results*

BAND 8 STORY

Leaving a stable job to start my own café was **a calculated risk**. I saved for two years, tested the menu on friends and kept a small reserve, so the fear was more manageable.

≈ **a measured risk** — o'lchangan xavf

≈ **a well-thought-out gamble** — o'ylab qilingan tavakkal

Qachon ishlatiladi: Xavf: take / run a calculated risk. 'calculated' - hisoblab chiqilgan. Part 3 da xavfning mantiqiy tomonini ko'rsatadi.

Namuna gap: Starting a company can be **a calculated risk** if you plan carefully.

SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

44 a sense of adventure

7/10 SPEAKING BALL

sarguzasht ruhi • *a wish to try new, exciting things*

BAND 8 STORY

My grandmother has **a sense of adventure** that surprises everyone. At seventy she decided to ride in a hot-air balloon, and she returned home with a huge smile and half a hundred photos.

≈ **a spirit of adventure** — sarguzasht ruhi

≈ **a taste for the unknown** — noma'lumga ishtiyoq

Qachon ishlatiladi: Xarakter: have / lack a sense of adventure. 'a' artikli. Part 3 'Why do some people enjoy risky challenges?' savoliga ijobiy javob.

Namuna gap: Young travellers often have **a sense of adventure** that takes them to remote places.

SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

45 overcome adversity

8/10 SPEAKING BALL

qiyinchiliklarni yengib o'tmoq • *to successfully deal with great difficulties or misfortune*

BAND 8 STORY

My neighbour grew up with little money, yet he managed to **overcome adversity** and become a doctor. Whenever he speaks to young people, he says that every obstacle taught him something.

≈ **defeat hardship** — qiyinchilikni yengmoq

≈ **triumph over hardship** — mashaqqat ustidan g'alaba qozonmoq

Qachon ishlatiladi: Rasmiy: overcome adversity / hardship / obstacles. 'adversity' sanalmaydigan ot. Part 3 da insonning kuchi haqida.

Namuna gap: Stories of people who **overcome adversity** inspire the whole community.

SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

46 emotional resilience

8/10 SPEAKING BALL

hissiy chidamlilik • *the ability to recover from sadness, stress or failure*

BAND 8 STORY

Children with **emotional resilience** don't fall apart after one failure. My nephew lost his first chess match, shook the other boy's hand and asked what he could do better, which impressed me.

≈ **mental strength** — ruhiy kuch

≈ **psychological toughness** — ruhiy chidamlilik

Qachon ishlatiladi: Part 3: develop / build emotional resilience (sanalmaydigan ot). 'resilience' - ot, 'resilient' - sifat. Tarbiya mavzusida akademik.

Namuna gap: Parents can help children develop **emotional resilience** by listening to them.

SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

47 wrap children in cotton wool

8/10 SPEAKING BALL

bolalarni haddan ortiq asramoq • *to protect children so much that they cannot learn from experience*

BAND 8 STORY

Some parents **wrap** their children **in cotton wool**, so the kids never climb a tree or take a bus alone. My mother did the opposite, and I am grateful that she trusted me.

≈ **be overprotective** — haddan ortiq asramoq

≈ **shelter children from every risk** — bolalarni har qanday xavfdan himoya qilmoq

Qachon ishlatiladi: Britancha idiom: wrap someone in cotton wool. Salbiy ohang. Part 3 'How can parents prepare children for difficulties?' savoliga mos.

Namuna gap: If we **wrap** children **in cotton wool**, they won't learn how to cope with problems.

SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

48 learn from failure

8/10 SPEAKING BALL

muvaffaqiyatsizlikdan o'rganmoq • *to understand your mistakes and use them to do better next time*

BAND 8 STORY

My teacher never punishes mistakes in class; instead we discuss them. That is how we **learn from failure**, and, honestly, I speak more bravely in her lessons than in any other.

≈ **learn from your mistakes** — xatolardan o'rganmoq

≈ **treat failure as a lesson** — muvaffaqiyatsizlikni saboq deb bilmoq

Qachon ishlatiladi: Part 3: learn from failure / mistakes. 'from' predlogi. Fikr bildirishda: failure is a great teacher. Bolalar tarbiyasi mavzusida.

Namuna gap: Children should be allowed to **learn from failure**.

SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

49 make their own mistakes

8/10 SPEAKING BALL

o'z xatolarini qilmoq • *to do things in their own way, including doing wrong, so that they can learn*

BAND 8 STORY

I tell my younger cousins that they have to **make their own mistakes**. I can give advice, but they will only remember a lesson when they feel it, as I did.

≈ **learn by trial and error** — sinash va xatolar orqali o'rganmoq

≈ **find things out for themselves** — o'zlari bilib olmoq

Qachon ishlatiladi: Part 3: let children make their own mistakes. 'make a mistake' (do emas!). Mustaqillik haqidagi fikr uchun; rasmiy emas.

Namuna gap: Parents should let teenagers **make their own mistakes** within safe limits.

SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

50 a safety net

8/10
SPEAKING BALL

ishonchli himoya, zaxira tayanch • *something that protects you if things go wrong*

BAND 8 STORY

Knowing my parents were there as **a safety net** gave me the courage to start my own project. If it failed, I could always come home, and that thought made me braver, not lazier.

≈ **something to fall back on** — tayanch zaxira

≈ **a support system** — qo‘llab-quvvatlash tizimi

Qachon ishlatiladi: Tavakkal va oila: provide / act as a safety net. ‘a’ artikli. Pul, oila va ijtimoiy yordam haqida; Part 3 da.

Namuna gap: Family support acts as **a safety net** for young people taking risks.

SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

Describe and explain

STRUCTURES 1 / 2

1 What I found hardest was + N / that + S + V

8/10 SPEAKING BALL

men uchun eng qiyini ... edi • *a cleft sentence that points out the most difficult part*

BAND 8 STORY

What I found hardest was not the work itself but the loneliness. After a day of lessons in a foreign language, I'd return to a silent room and miss the noise of my family.

≈ **The hardest part was + N** — eng qiyin tomoni ... edi

≈ **What really got to me was + N** — meni eng ko'p qiynagani ...

Qachon ishlatiladi: Qiyinchilikni ta'riflash: What I found hardest was + ot / that-gap / -ing. 'found' o'tgan zamonda. Part 2 'what it was' qismini yorqin qiladi.

Namuna gap: **What I found hardest was** speaking in front of strangers.

SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

2 No matter how + adj + S + V, S + V

8/10 SPEAKING BALL

qanchalik ... bo'lmasin, ... • *it says that something is true in every case, however strong the condition*

BAND 8 STORY

No matter how tired I was, I made myself revise for an hour every evening. I told myself that the tiredness was temporary, but the exam would be real.

≈ **However + adj + S + V, ...** — qanchalik ... bo'lsa ham

≈ **Whatever + S + V, ...** — nima bo'lsa ham

Qachon ishlatiladi: Qat'iyat: No matter how + sifat + ega + fe'l, bosh gap. 'No matter how hard' ham bo'ladi. Part 1 va 2 da qat'iyatni ko'rsatadi.

Namuna gap: **No matter how** difficult the task seems, you should at least try.

SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

3 Faced with + N, S + V

8/10 SPEAKING BALL

... ga duch kelib, ... • *a participle phrase showing the situation that made you act*

BAND 8 STORY

Faced with a sudden change of plans, I had no choice but to improvise. I rewrote my speech on the bus, and by the time I stepped on stage, I felt oddly calm.

≈ **When faced with + N, S + V** — ... ga duch kelganda

≈ **Confronted with + N, S + V** — ... ga to'qnash kelib

Qachon ishlatiladi: Qiyinchilik: Faced with + ot, ega + fe'l (ega bir xil bo'lishi kerak). Rasmiyroq; Part 1 va 2 da muammoga munosabatni ko'rsatadi.

Namuna gap: **Faced with** a difficult choice, I asked my parents for advice.

SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

4 S + V, which + V + N

8/10 SPEAKING BALL

..., bu esa ... edi • *a non-defining relative clause that comments on the whole previous clause*

BAND 8 STORY

I failed my first driving test, **which** felt like the end of the world at the time. Looking back, it was the best thing that could have happened, because it made me more careful.

≈ **S + V, and that made + O + V** — ..., bu esa ... qildi

≈ **S + V, a fact that + V** — ..., bu holat ...

Qachon ishlatiladi: Butun gapga izoh: ..., which + fe'l. Vergul majburiy; bunda 'that' ishlatilmaydi! Part 2 da voqeaga his-tuyg'u va baho qo'shadi.

Namuna gap: She passed the exam, **which** surprised everyone.

SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

5 Rather than + V-ing, S + V

7/10 SPEAKING BALL

... o'rniga, ... • *it shows what you chose to do instead of another action*

BAND 8 STORY

Rather than panicking, I took a deep breath and listed what I could control. That simple habit changed the way I handle stress, and I use it before every exam now.

≈ **Instead of + V-ing, S + V** — ... o'rniga, ...

≈ **S + V instead of + V-ing** — ... o'rniga ...

Qachon ishlatiladi: Tanlov: Rather than + V-ing, ega + fe'l. 'instead of' dan rasmiyroq. Part 2 'what you did' qismi uchun juda mos.

Namuna gap: **Rather than** giving up, he asked for extra help.

SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

6 get + p.p. (get stuck, get stressed)

6/10 SPEAKING BALL

... bo'lib qolmoq (norasmiy passiv) • *an informal passive that shows a change or an accident*

BAND 8 STORY

On the day of the exam I **got stuck** in traffic and **got** so **stressed** that I forgot my pen. A stranger lent me one, and that small kindness calmed me immediately.

≈ **become + adj** — ... bo'lmoq

≈ **end up + V-ing** — oxiri ... bo'lib qolmoq

Qachon ishlatiladi: Norasmiy passiv: get stuck / lost / tired / stressed. 'be' dan jonliroq; kutilmagan hodisalar haqida. Rasmiy yozuvda ishlatmang. Part 1 va 2 da.

Namuna gap: We **got lost** in the old town, but that made the evening more fun.

SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

Tell the story and reflect

7 If I were to + V, I would + V

8/10 SPEAKING BALL

agar yana qilsam, ... qilardim • *a hypothetical that says what you would do if you could repeat something*

BAND 8 STORY

If I were to do it again, **I would** start earlier and ask for help sooner. I wasted two weeks pretending that I could do everything alone, and that was my real mistake.

≈ **Given the chance, I would + V** — imkon bo'lsa, ...

≈ **If I could go back, I'd + V** — agar qaytsam, ...

Qachon ishlatiladi: O'z tajribangizni baholash: If I were to + fe'l, I would + fe'l ('was' emas, 'were'). Part 2 xulosasida 'what I learned' uchun yaxshi.

Namuna gap: **If I were to** repeat that trip, **I would** pack much lighter.

SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

8 Little did I know that + S + V

9/10 SPEAKING BALL

... deb xayolimga ham kelmagan edi • *an inversion for an unexpected result*

BAND 8 STORY

Little did I know that the hardest week of my life would also teach me the most. I thought I was just surviving, but every small decision was building a stronger version of me.

≈ **I had no idea that + S + V** — xayolimga ham kelmagan edi

≈ **Never had I imagined that + S + V** — hech tasavvur qilmagan edim

Qachon ishlatiladi: Kutilmagan natija: Little did I know / realise that + gap. 'Little' dan keyin did + ega + asosiy fe'l. Part 2 da dramatik taranglik beradi.

Namuna gap: **Little did I know** that one phone call would change my plans.

SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

9 Only later did + S + V

8/10 SPEAKING BALL

faqat keyinroq ... • *an inversion that shows you understood something after the event*

BAND 8 STORY

Only later did I understand why my coach was so strict. At the time I thought he was just angry, but by the end of the season I could see that every harsh word had a purpose.

≈ **It was only later that + S + V** — faqat keyinroq ...

≈ **In hindsight, S + V** — keyin tushunsam, ...

Qachon ishlatiladi: Kech anglash: Only later did + ega + fe'l (asosiy shakl). 'later' o'rniga 'then', 'after', 'when' ham ishlatiladi. Part 2 'what you learned' qismiga mos.

Namuna gap: **Only later did** I realise how brave my mother had been.

SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

10 It dawned on me that + S + V

8/10 SPEAKING BALL

birdan ongimga yetdiki ... • *it says that you suddenly understood something*

BAND 8 STORY

Halfway through the climb **it dawned on me that** I was stronger than I thought. My legs hurt, but I had already passed the point where I wanted to quit, and the peak suddenly seemed possible.

≈ **I suddenly realised that + S + V** — birdan angladimki ...

≈ **It struck me that + S + V** — xayolimga keldiki ...

Qachon ishlatiladi: Tushunish lahzasi: It dawned on me that + gap. 'dawn' - tong otmoq, ya'ni 'ravshan bo'ldi'. Part 2 da burilish nuqtasini jonli ko'rsatadi.

Namuna gap: **It dawned on me that** I had been worrying about the wrong problem.

SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

11 Whether + S + V or + S + V, S + V

7/10 SPEAKING BALL

... bo'lsa ham, bo'lmasa ham, ... • *it says that the result does not change, in either case*

BAND 8 STORY

Whether I passed **or** failed, I knew I had grown. I walked out of the hall tired but strangely light, because for the first time I had not run away from a challenge.

≈ **Win or lose, S + V** — yutsam ham, yutqazsam ham, ...

≈ **Regardless of whether + S + V, ...** — ... ekanligidan qat'i nazar

Qachon ishlatiladi: Natijadan qat'i nazar: Whether + gap + or (not / gap), bosh gap. 'or' ni unutmang. Part 2 xulosasida va Part 3 da keng ishlatiladi.

Namuna gap: **Whether** you succeed **or** not, the experience will teach you something.

SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

12 It is thanks to + N that + S + V

8/10 SPEAKING BALL

... tufayli ... • *a cleft sentence that gives credit to a person or an experience*

BAND 8 STORY

It is thanks to that difficult year **that** I am now so patient. I learnt to wait, to listen and to solve one problem at a time, and my friends say that I am a different person.

≈ **Thanks to + N, S + V** — ... tufayli, ...

≈ **I owe it to + N that + S + V** — ... ning arzandasi

Qachon ishlatiladi: Minnatdorchilik: It is thanks to + ot that + gap. 'because of' dan ijobiyroq. Part 2 va 3 da tajribaning foydasini ko'rsatadi.

Namuna gap: **It is thanks to** early mistakes **that** I can now teach others.

SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

SAMPLE CUE CARD

Describe a tough challenge you have faced.

Describe a tough challenge you have faced.

You should say:

- what it was
- when it happened
- what you did
- what you learned

My 1-minute notes

- final year at university • last spring • night job
- print shop • evenings till eleven • exams in May • a daunting task
- steep learning curve • out of my comfort zone • February to May
- weighed up my options • one step at a time • burnt out • reached out for support
- reasons: learnt the hard way • came out stronger • build character
- wrap-up: a blessing in disguise • if I were to do it again • grew as a person

SAMPLE ANSWER • BAND 8

I • Intro (what)	I'd like to talk about a tough challenge I faced last spring, in my final year at university. I had agreed to work evenings at my uncle's print shop while preparing for my final exams, and it turned out to be a daunting task.
P • When it happened	It all happened between February and May. I finished classes at four, worked until eleven and then studied until my eyes closed. It was a steep learning curve, because I had never managed my own time before, and for the first few weeks I felt completely out of my comfort zone.
P • What I did	Rather than quitting either of them, I weighed up my options and decided to take it one step at a time. I broke my day into small blocks and wrote three priorities on a sticky note every morning. Even so, I burnt out in April and lost sleep over my grades, until I finally reached out for support. My older sister cooked dinner for me twice a week, and that made all the difference.
E • Reason 1	The first thing I learnt is that you can't do everything alone. What I found hardest was admitting that I needed help, and I learnt the hard way that pride only makes problems bigger.
E • Reason 2	On top of that, I came out of it stronger. Little did I know that those exhausting months would build my character, but now I can stay calm under pressure, and I take hard tasks in my stride.
W • Wrap-up	So, all in all, it was a blessing in disguise. If I were to do it again, I would start earlier and ask for help sooner, but I definitely grew as a person, and I'm proud that I got through it.

UPGRADE YOUR TALK

Tell a story, not a list

Instead of…	Say…
a very hard job	a daunting task
too much to ask	a tall order
outside what I know	out of my comfort zone
I had no preparation	I was thrown in at the deep end
I had to learn fast	it was a steep learning curve
I took on too much	I bit off more than I could chew
a bad period	a rough patch
a big problem	a major hurdle
I was very stressed	I was under immense pressure
I did well in the challenge	I rose to the challenge
I faced the problem directly	I tackled it head-on
I did it slowly, bit by bit	I took it one step at a time
I stayed calm	I kept a cool head
I reacted fast	I thought on my feet
I asked friends for help	I reached out for support
I felt terrible	I hit rock bottom
I couldn't sleep from worry	I lost sleep over it
I was too tired to go on	I burnt out
I almost stopped	I was on the verge of giving up
it damaged my health	it took its toll
I learnt from a bad experience	I learnt the hard way
I became stronger	I came out stronger
a bad thing that was good	a blessing in disguise
it made me wiser	I grew as a person
let children try and fail	let them make their own mistakes